



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

*sphurato+anantarūpeṇa prakṛtiṃ ca na paśyataḥ |
kva bandhaḥ kva ca vā mokṣaḥ kva harṣaḥ kva viṣādatā | | 18 | 72 | |
buddhiparyantaśāre māyāmātraṃ vivartate |
nirmamo nirahaṃkāro niṣkāmaḥ śobhate budhaḥ | | 18 | 73 | |
akṣayaṃ gatasantāpamātmānaṃ paśyato muneḥ |
kva vidyā kva ca vā viśvaṃ kva deho+ahaṃ mameti vā | | 18 | 74 | |*

— Aṣṭāvakraḡītā, Prakaraṇa 18 (Chapter 18), Verses 72-74

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

Imagine the boundless expanse of existence, teeming with infinite forms, yet you perceive no separate "nature" or Prakriti as distinct from yourself. Where, then, could bondage or liberation possibly exist? Where joy or sorrow? This verse points to the realization that the universe is not an external entity to be interacted with, but rather a manifestation of the Self. Once this truth is grasped, the very concepts of being bound by worldly experiences or seeking liberation from them become irrelevant. Joy and sorrow, too, lose their sting, understood as fleeting emotions within the vastness of being.

The universe, as perceived through the intellect, is merely a play of illusion, a mirage. The wise one, free from possessiveness and ego, shines forth in their true nature, unburdened by desires. This isn't advocating for apathy, but rather detachment from the ego's incessant cravings and anxieties. By relinquishing the illusion of control and ownership, you discover a profound peace and contentment that transcends the ephemeral nature of worldly pursuits. You become a beacon of serenity, untouched by the turbulence of the external world.

For the sage who beholds the imperishable Self, forever free from suffering, where is the need for knowledge, or the perception of a separate universe? Where is the body, the "I," or the "mine"? This speaks to the ultimate dissolution of the individual self into the universal Self. Once you recognize your true identity as the eternal, unchanging Atman, the pursuit of external knowledge becomes superfluous. The world, the body, and the ego, all perceived as distinct entities, are understood as temporary constructs of the mind. The concept of "mine" loses its grip as you realize that everything is ultimately a part of the One. This understanding liberates you from the cycle of attachment and suffering, allowing you to dwell in the eternal bliss of your true nature. This is not about negating experience, but about experiencing it from a place of non-identification, where you are the witness rather than the actor.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

If you truly believed that you were boundless and free, how would you approach the challenges and opportunities in your life today?